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TOWNS AND FORTRESSES OF KIEV AND PEREYASLAVL

A Gazetteer of Middle Dnieper, Porossia and Posullya Settlements

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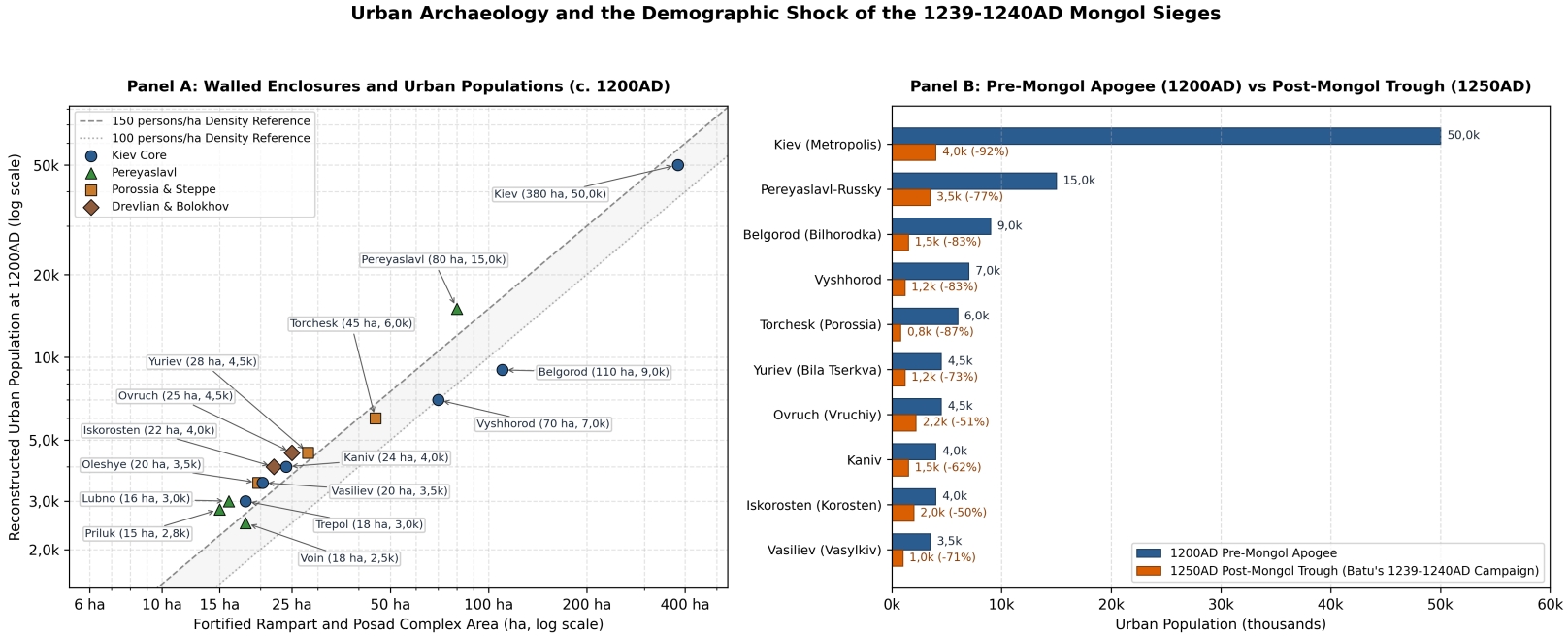


Figure 1. Excavated rampart and posad areas (in hectares) plotted against urban population across the ~265k km^2 Middle and Lower Dnieper basin in 1200AD — led by Kiev (380 ha, 50k), Pereyaslavl-Russky (80 ha, 15k), Belgorod (100 ha, 9k) and Vyshhorod (70 ha, 7k) — and the divergent demographic trajectories of the Middle Dnieper capitals, the Porossia-Posullya frontier forts and the wooded Drevlian towns between 1200AD and 1300AD.

Abstract

This gazetteer presents population series for 145 excavated settlements across the ~265k km^2 Middle and Lower Dnieper basin from the Upper Palaeolithic (10000BC) to the Golden Horde appanage era (1300AD) [1][2][3]. The prehistoric and ancient tables cover 52 sites, moving from the mammoth-bone camps of Mezhirich and Kirillovskaya (80 - 160 inhabitants in 10000BC) to the Trypillia BII-CI concentric proto-towns of the Cherkasy-Uman plateau at 3600BC (Talianky at 15k, Maidanetske at 10k and Nebelivka at 9k) and the Scythian forest-steppe hillforts and Greek colonies of 500BC (Pontic Olbia at 15k, Belsk-Gelonus at 12k, Kamenskoye at 6k and Trakhtemyriv at 4,5k) [4][5][6].

Across the 95 medieval Rus towns and frontier fortresses (1000AD - 1300AD), urban growth peaked in 1200AD under the protection of the Stuhna, Irpin, Ros (Porossia) and Sula (Posullya) rampart lines. Kiev rose from 28k in 1000AD to 50k in 1200AD across 380 ha, flanked by Belgorod (9k), Vyshhorod (7k), Pereyaslavl-Russky (15k), the Chorni Klobuky frontier capital of Torchesk (6k) and the Drevlian centres of

Ovruch (4,5k) and Iskorosten (4k). Batu Khan's campaigns of 1239-1240AD devastated the exposed forest-steppe forts and reduced Kiev to 4k in 1250AD (8,5k in 1300AD) and Pereyaslavl to 3,5k (4,5k in 1300AD), whereas the wooded Drevlian towns retained half of their inhabitants and the tribute-paying Bolokhov towns survived intact until Daniel of Galicia's punitive expedition of 1257AD [7][8][9].

Methodology

Across the Middle and Lower Dnieper (~265k km^2), archaeological excavations and Rus chronicles document 145 principal settlements between the Upper Palaeolithic (10000BC), the Mongol campaigns of 1239-1240 and the Golden Horde appanage era (1250AD - 1300AD) [1][2][3].

Population Estimation from Archaeological Evidence

Population estimates for individual towns and villages draw on excavated site areas, medieval rampart circuits and post-Mongol destruction layers.

For prehistoric and Early Iron Age sites (10000BC - 500BC), Upper Palaeolithic and Neolithic figures (10000BC - 6000BC) are based on the mammoth-bone dwelling rings at Mezhirich, Dobranichevka, Gontsy and Kirillovskaya (100 - 250 inhabitants) and the Dnieper-Donets cemeteries at Nikolskoye and Vovnigi (300 - 450 inhabitants) [4][10]. Trypillia BII-CI figures (3600BC) follow geomagnetic house counts across the Cherkasy-Uman plateau between the Ros and the Southern Bug (Talianky at 450 ha with ~2,7k houses; Maidanetske at 200 ha with ~2,1k houses; Nebelivka at 260 ha with ~1,45k houses; and Dobrovody at 250 ha), assuming 75 - 80% of the houses were occupied at the same time by 5,5 - 6,5 persons per two-storey *ploshchadka* homestead [4][11][12]. Scythian forest-steppe hillfort and Greek colonial figures (500BC) follow excavated housing quarters at Belsk (Gelonus, 4,02k ha perimeter, 152,6 ha across the Western, Eastern and Kuzeminsk forts, 12k), Trakhtemyriv (500 ha, 4,5k), Motronyn (200 ha, 4k), Nemirov (110 ha, 4k) and the 50 ha stone-walled town of Olbia (15k) [5][6][13].

For Kievan Rus fortified towns (*gorodishcha*) and suburbs (*posady*, 800AD - 1240AD), following P. P. Tolochko [1][14], A. V. Kuza [2][15] and M. A. Sahaydak [16], towns are divided into the inner citadel (*detinets*), outer walled town (*okolny gorod*) and unfortified riverside craft suburbs (*posady* and *podol*). Inside the densely built *detinets* and *okolny gorod* ramparts, average homestead (*usadba*) plots measure 300 - 500 m^2 (20 - 25 homesteads per hectare at 5,5 - 6 persons per household, or 110 - 150 persons/ha). In outer *posad* quarters and the cavalry towns of the Porossia and Posullya frontier lines, wider courtyard plots (600 - 900 m^2) give 70 - 110 persons/ha [3][8].

For the Mongol conquest and late thirteenth-century recovery (1240AD - 1300AD), estimates reflect the 1239-1240AD destruction layers across Pereyaslavl, Posullya, Porossia and Kiev, John of Plano Carpini's 1246AD eyewitness report of ~200 surviving households in Kievan *Podol* (4k inhabitants in Kiev in 1250AD, recovering to 8,5k by 1300AD according to H. Yu. Ivakin) and the survival of the Drevlian Polesia and Bolokhov Land towns prior to Daniel of Galicia's 1257AD campaign [7][9][17].

Results

Prehistoric and Early Iron Age Sites

Upper Palaeolithic, Neolithic, Trypillia and Bronze Age Settlements

Site Name	Coordinates (N, E)	District	10000BC	6000BC	3600BC / 2000BC
Talianky	48,8°N, 30,53°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	-	-	15k / 600
Maidanetske	48,82°N, 30,69°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	-	-	10k / 500
Nebelivka	48,64°N, 30,56°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	-	-	9k / 450
Dobrovody	48,77°N, 30,38°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	-	-	8,5k / 450
Vesely Kut	48,93°N, 30,62°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	-	-	5k / 400
Sushkivka	48,67°N, 30,37°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	-	-	4,5k / 350
Kosenivka	48,84°N, 30,45°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	-	-	4k / 350
Chichirkozovka	49°N, 31,09°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	-	-	3,5k / 300
Tomashevka	48,61°N, 30,3°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	-	-	3,5k / 300
Yampil-Trypillia	48,72°N, 30,78°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	-	-	2,8k / 350
Vladyslavchyk	49,05°N, 29,86°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	-	-	2,5k / 300
Trepol (Trypillia)	50,12°N, 30,77°E	Kiev Core	-	-	2,5k / -
Mikhailovka	47,29°N, 33,95°E	Lower Dnieper & Steppe	-	-	1,5k / 1,8k
Dereivka	48,91°N, 33,68°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	-	380	1,4k / 1,2k
Kolomyishchyna	50,12°N, 30,9°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	-	-	1,2k / 350
Subotiv	49,09°N, 32,55°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	-	-	- / 1,2k
Chapaievka	50,34°N, 30,56°E	Kiev Core	-	-	1k / 450
Sofievka	50,29°N, 30,92°E	Left-Bank Pereyaslavl	-	-	900 / 700
Pustynka	51,41°N, 30,65°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	-	-	- / 800
Nosachevo	49,18°N, 31,69°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	-	-	- / 900
Kirillovskaya	50,48°N, 30,48°E	Kiev Core	160	250	-
Mezhirich	49,62°N, 31,43°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	150	200	-
Gontsy	50,17°N, 32,82°E	Left-Bank Posullya	140	190	-
Dobranichevka	50,15°N, 31,83°E	Left-Bank Pereyaslavl	120	180	-
Semenovka	50,23°N, 31,54°E	Left-Bank Pereyaslavl	110	170	-

Fastov Palaeolithic	50,08°N, 29,92°E	Right-Bank Middle Dnieper	100	160	-
Nikolskoye	48,21°N, 35,17°E	Lower Dnieper & Steppe	90	450	600 / -
Vovnigi	48,12°N, 35,14°E	Lower Dnieper & Steppe	80	420	550 / -
Buzky	48,03°N, 31,21°E	Drevlian & Bolokhov Land	-	350	700 / -

Table 1. Estimated inhabitants of the 29 principal excavated Upper Palaeolithic, Dnieper-Donets Neolithic, Trypillia BII-CI concentric mega-sites and Bronze Age settlements across the Middle and Lower Dnieper, 10000BC - 2000BC. Slash-separated entries in the final column give population at 3600BC and 2000BC; dashes indicate unoccupied periods.

Scythian Hillforts, Greek Poleis, Zarubintsy and Chernyakhov Centres

Site Name	Coordinates (N, E)	Period & Type	500BC	300AD	600AD
Olbia (Pontic Olbia)	46,69°N, 31,9°E	Milesian Greek Polis (50 ha)	15k	4k	-
Belsk (Gelonus)	50,09°N, 34,63°E	Scythian Giant Hillfort (4,02k ha)	12k	1,5k	-
Kamenskoye	47,49°N, 34,42°E	Scythian Steppe Hillfort (1,2k ha)	6k	1,1k	-
Trakhtemyriv	49,98°N, 31,36°E	Scythian Giant Hillfort (500 ha)	4,5k	1k	-
Motronyn	49,14°N, 32,26°E	Scythian Giant Hillfort (200 ha)	4k	900	-
Nemirov Hillfort	48,97°N, 28,84°E	Scythian Giant Hillfort (110 ha)	4k	1,1k	-
Basovka Hillfort	50,85°N, 33,67°E	Scythian Sula Hillfort (170 ha)	3k	800	-
Berezan (Borysthenes)	46,6°N, 31,41°E	Milesian Greek Island Emporium	2,5k	600	-
Khotiv Hillfort	50,33°N, 30,47°E	Scythian Kievan Hillfort (31 ha)	2,5k	900	-
Pastyrskoye	48,89°N, 31,79°E	Scythian & Antae Craft Hillfort (25 ha)	2,5k	1,4k	2,5k
Sharpivka	48,9°N, 31,7°E	Scythian Craft Hillfort	2k	800	-
Roden (Knyazha Hora)	49,69°N, 31,54°E	Scythian & Rus Hillfort	1,8k	-	-
Makeyevka Scythian	48,94°N, 31,64°E	Scythian Hillfort	1,5k	700	-
Glubokaya Pristan	46,64°N, 32,17°E	Olbiopolitan Chora Fortress	1,2k	500	-
Zolota Balka	47,38°N, 33,96°E	Late Scythian Stone Fortress	900	1,8k	-
Lyubimovka	46,82°N, 33,57°E	Late Scythian Stone Fortress	850	1,6k	-

Gavrilovka	47,23°N, 33,86°E	Late Scythian Stone Fortress	800	1,5k	-
Chernyakhiv	50,01°N, 30,78°E	Chernyakhov Culture Type-Site	-	1,5k	600
Pilipenkova Hora	49,73°N, 31,52°E	Zarubintsy & Chernyakhov Hillfort	800	1,4k	700
Kompaniiets	49,92°N, 31,59°E	Chernyakhov Left-Bank Centre	-	1,4k	600
Velikaya Bugaevka	50,22°N, 30,42°E	Zarubintsy & Chernyakhov Village	-	1,2k	550
Liutezh	50,69°N, 30,4°E	Zarubintsy Iron-Smelting Complex	-	900	600
Monastyrek	49,97°N, 31,39°E	Early Slavic Hillfort	-	-	900

Table 2. Estimated inhabitants of the 23 principal Scythian forest-steppe hillforts, Milesian Greek colonial poleis, Zarubintsy riverine forts and Roman-era Chernyakhov settlements across the Middle and Lower Dnieper, 500BC - 600AD.

Kievan Rus and the Principalities

Principality of Kiev and the Right-Bank Ring

Settlement	Coordinates (N, E)	1000AD	1200AD	1250AD	1300AD
Kiev	50,45°N, 30,52°E	28k	50k	4k	8,5k
Belgorod (Bilhorodka)	50,39°N, 30,23°E	6k	9k	1,5k	2,2k
Vyshhorod	50,58°N, 30,49°E	5k	7k	1,2k	1,8k
Kaniv	49,75°N, 31,47°E	2,2k	4k	1,5k	2,2k
Vasiliev (Vasylkiv)	50,18°N, 30,32°E	2,5k	3,5k	1k	1,4k
Trepol (Trypillia)	50,12°N, 30,77°E	2k	3k	900	1,2k
Berestovo (Pechersk)	50,44°N, 30,56°E	1,2k	3k	600	1,1k
Roden (Knyazha Hora)	49,69°N, 31,54°E	1,6k	2,5k	400	-
Vitichev	50,13°N, 30,89°E	1,8k	2,2k	500	700
Chuchin	49,92°N, 31,43°E	1k	1,8k	450	600
Zvenyhorod-Kievan	50,25°N, 30,4°E	900	1,6k	450	600
Zarub	49,97°N, 31,4°E	1k	1,5k	400	500
Kitaigorod (Kitaevo)	50,37°N, 30,54°E	1,2k	1,5k	450	650
Ivan-Gorod (Rzhyshchiv)	49,97°N, 31,05°E	800	1,5k	450	650
Khalep	50,1°N, 30,82°E	800	1,4k	450	600
Tumasch	50,14°N, 30,64°E	800	1,4k	400	550
Zdvyzhen (Brusyliv)	50,29°N, 29,53°E	750	1,4k	550	700
Khodosivka	50,27°N, 30,52°E	900	1,35k	450	600
Krasn	50,03°N, 30,67°E	700	1,3k	400	550
Svyatoslavl	50,16°N, 30,71°E	700	1,2k	350	450
Mutyzhin	50,44°N, 29,92°E	600	1,2k	450	600

Plesetskoye	50,22°N, 30,11°E	650	1,2k	400	550
Dymer	50,78°N, 30,3°E	650	1,2k	500	650
Olzhychi	50,19°N, 30,82°E	750	1,15k	400	500
Zhelanya (Zhuliany)	50,39°N, 30,44°E	600	1,1k	350	500
Byshiv	50,27°N, 29,89°E	600	1,1k	450	600
Unava-Fastovets	50,06°N, 30,02°E	600	1,1k	400	500
Hlibivka	50,81°N, 30,36°E	600	1,1k	450	600
Yasnohorodka	50,35°N, 30,03°E	550	1,05k	400	500
Velyka Snitynka	50,09°N, 29,97°E	600	1,05k	350	450
Boyarka-Budayivka	50,33°N, 30,3°E	550	1k	350	450
Hostomel	50,57°N, 30,27°E	600	1k	400	550
Vorobiev	50,63°N, 30,23°E	550	950	350	450
Vorzel-Irpin	50,54°N, 30,22°E	550	950	350	450

Table 3. Estimated inhabitants of the 34 chronicle towns, princely residences and Dnieper cliff fortresses in Kiev and the Right-Bank Stuhna-Irpin defensive ring from the reign of Vladimir the Great (1000AD) through the December 1240AD Mongol siege to 1300AD.

Porossia Steppe-Frontier Line, Drevlian Land and Bolokhov Land

Settlement	Coordinates (N, E)	District	1000AD	1200AD	1250AD / 1300AD
Torchesk (Olshanitsa)	49,68°N, 30,63°E	Porossia Frontier	2k	6k	800 / 1,1k
Yuriev (Bila Tserkva)	49,79°N, 30,12°E	Porossia Frontier	1,5k	4,5k	1,2k / 2k
Korsun	49,42°N, 31,26°E	Porossia Frontier	1,2k	2,8k	700 / 1,1k
Boguslavl	49,55°N, 30,88°E	Porossia Frontier	1k	2,5k	650 / 1k
Volodarev	49,52°N, 29,92°E	Porossia Frontier	800	1,8k	500 / 750
Rostovets	49,7°N, 29,44°E	Porossia Frontier	850	1,8k	550 / 800
Dveren	49,59°N, 30,73°E	Porossia Frontier	-	1,5k	400 / 550
Polksten	49,72°N, 31,22°E	Porossia Frontier	700	1,5k	400 / 550
Moshny	49,53°N, 31,75°E	Porossia Frontier	700	1,3k	450 / 650
Neyatin	49,75°N, 29,79°E	Porossia Frontier	650	1,25k	350 / 500
Bakhmutov	49,63°N, 30,49°E	Porossia Frontier	-	1,2k	350 / 450
Chernyi Klobuk	49,64°N, 30,82°E	Porossia Frontier	-	1,15k	350 / 450
Sakkov	49,74°N, 30,32°E	Porossia Frontier	-	1,1k	300 / 400
Churilovo	49,78°N, 29,59°E	Porossia Frontier	600	1,1k	350 / 450
Mykhailiv-Porossia	49,49°N, 31,06°E	Porossia Frontier	-	1,05k	300 / 400
Borovyi	49,66°N, 30,22°E	Porossia Frontier	-	1k	300 / 400
Ovruch (Vruchiy)	51,33°N, 28,81°E	Drevlian Polesia	2,8k	4,5k	2,2k / 3k
Iskorosten (Korosten)	50,95°N, 28,65°E	Drevlian Polesia	2,6k	4k	2k / 2,6k
Vozvyagl (Zviahel)	50,59°N, 27,62°E	Drevlian Polesia	1,5k	2,8k	1,4k / 1,5k
Bolokhov (Lyubar)	49,92°N, 27,76°E	Bolokhov Land	1,2k	2,5k	2,2k / 1,4k
Mezhibozhye	49,44°N, 27,41°E	Bolokhov Land	1k	2,2k	1,7k / 1,5k
Kotelnich	50,11°N, 28,97°E	Drevlian Polesia	1k	2k	1k / 1,3k

Horodsk	50,37°N, 29,19°E	Drevlian Polesia	1,4k	2k	950 / 1,2k
Gubin	49,79°N, 27,45°E	Bolokhov Land	900	2k	1,7k / 1k
Bozhsky	49,47°N, 27,5°E	Bolokhov Land	1,1k	2k	1,6k / 1,1k
Malyn	50,77°N, 29,24°E	Drevlian Polesia	1,3k	1,8k	950 / 1,2k
Zhytomyr	50,25°N, 28,66°E	Drevlian Polesia	1,2k	1,8k	1k / 1,5k
Raiky	49,92°N, 28,5°E	Drevlian Polesia	1,3k	1,8k	300 / -
Kudin	49,52°N, 27,29°E	Bolokhov Land	800	1,8k	1,5k / 950
Michesk (Radomyshl)	50,5°N, 29,24°E	Drevlian Polesia	1k	1,6k	800 / 1,05k
Kobud	49,75°N, 27,22°E	Bolokhov Land	750	1,6k	1,35k / 850
Derevich	49,77°N, 27,59°E	Bolokhov Land	750	1,6k	1,35k / 850
Ushchesk (Ushomyr)	50,86°N, 28,47°E	Drevlian Polesia	950	1,5k	800 / 1k
Chornobyl	51,28°N, 30,22°E	Drevlian Polesia	700	1,5k	900 / 1,2k
Olevsk	51,23°N, 27,65°E	Drevlian Polesia	950	1,4k	850 / 1,1k
Chudnov	50,06°N, 28,12°E	Drevlian Polesia	750	1,35k	750 / 950
Norinsk	51,27°N, 28,62°E	Drevlian Polesia	800	1,25k	700 / 850

Table 4. Estimated inhabitants of the 37 fortified towns across the Chorni Klobuky Porossia frontier line, wooded Drevlian Polesia and the tribute-paying Bolokhov Land, 1000AD - 1300AD. Slash-separated entries in the final column give population in 1250AD and 1300AD, showing the Bolokhov decline after Daniel of Galicia's 1257AD campaign.

Principality of Pereyaslavl, Posullya and Lower Dnieper

Settlement	Coordinates (N, E)	District	1000AD	1200AD	1250AD / 1300AD
Pereyaslavl-Russky	50,07°N, 31,46°E	Pereyaslavl Core	8k	15k	3,5k / 4,5k
Oleshye	46,62°N, 32,62°E	Lower Dnieper	2,4k	3,5k	1,2k / 1,5k
Lubno (Lubny)	50,02°N, 33°E	Posullya Line	1,5k	3k	900 / 1,2k
Priluk (Pryluky)	50,59°N, 32,39°E	Pereyaslavl Core	1,4k	2,8k	850 / 1,15k
Voin	49,57°N, 32,73°E	Posullya Line	1,5k	2,5k	500 / 600
Romen (Romny)	50,75°N, 33,48°E	Posullya Line	1,8k	2,5k	800 / 1,1k
Oster (Gorodets)	50,95°N, 30,88°E	Pereyaslavl Core	1,2k	2,5k	800 / 1,1k
Rimiv	50,63°N, 33,49°E	Posullya Line	1,2k	2,2k	450 / 550
Nosivka	50,93°N, 31,58°E	Pereyaslavl Core	1,1k	2,2k	700 / 950
Ltava (Poltava)	49,59°N, 34,55°E	Left-Bank Vorskla	1,3k	2,2k	700 / 950
Lukoml	49,85°N, 32,97°E	Posullya Line	1k	2k	550 / 750
Khorol	49,78°N, 33,27°E	Posullya Line	1k	2k	600 / 800
Ksniatin	50,2°N, 33,17°E	Posullya Line	1,1k	2k	500 / 650
Donets (Khorosheve)	49,85°N, 36,22°E	Seversky Donets	1,4k	2k	550 / 700
Sneporod	49,93°N, 32,99°E	Posullya Line	950	1,8k	400 / 500
Baruch	50,29°N, 31,7°E	Pereyaslavl Core	950	1,8k	550 / 750
Khortytsia (Protolche)	47,82°N, 35,07°E	Lower Dnieper	1,2k	1,8k	600 / 800
Bronnitsa	50,72°N, 31,37°E	Pereyaslavl Core	850	1,6k	500 / 650

Sinets	50,35°N, 33,33°E	Posullya Line	800	1,5k	450 / 600
Glinsk	50,61°N, 33,33°E	Posullya Line	1k	1,5k	550 / 800
Pesochen (Gorodok)	50,4°N, 30,66°E	Pereyaslavl Core	800	1,5k	450 / 600
Goltav	49,42°N, 33,77°E	Left-Bank Psyol	750	1,5k	450 / 600
Zheldi	49,69°N, 32,85°E	Posullya Line	-	1,4k	350 / 450
Bititsa	51,02°N, 34,94°E	Severian Border	1,2k	1,4k	-

Table 5. Estimated inhabitants of the 24 fortified towns across the Principality of Pereyaslavl, the 180 km Posullya rampart line and the Lower Dnieper ports of Oleshye and Khortytsia, 1000AD - 1300AD. Slash-separated entries in the final column give population in 1250AD and 1300AD following Möngke and Batu's March 1239AD offensive.

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